StoryCast: Research, Planning and Design Documentation

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Deliverable links

Deliverable	Where
GitHub repository	[paste public repo link: github.com/your-username/storycast]
Figma file (all design work)	https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM
Wireframes (Figma page: Wireframes)	https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=0-1
High-fidelity mockups (Figma page: Mockups)	https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=1-2
Design system (Figma page: Design System)	https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=1-3
Sitemap and hierarchy	Section 3 below, and docs/storycast-sitemap.pdf
Source code	index.html, about.html, story/, sass/, css/, assets/

The Figma file must be shared with 'Anyone with the link can view' for these links to open for a marker.

1. Project overview

StoryCast is a three-page accessible microsite for short audio and video stories. It is built with semantic HTML5, Sass with cascade layers and BEM, CSS Grid, Flexbox and one container-queried component, with no frameworks. Its pages are Home (index.html), Story Detail (story/night-market.html with video and story/river-radio.html with audio) and About and Access (about.html). The visual direction is a monochrome editorial look: near-black ink on warm off-white paper, a black hero, Baskerville-style serif headings and a clean sans-serif body.

Design goals

- **Every story has a text equivalent:** captions on video and a transcript on every story.
- **Few pages, clear paths:** one nav bar, three page types, no dead ends.
- **Content first:** a restrained black, white and grey palette keeps attention on the stories and gives strong contrast.
- **Accessibility as a design input,** not a late fix.

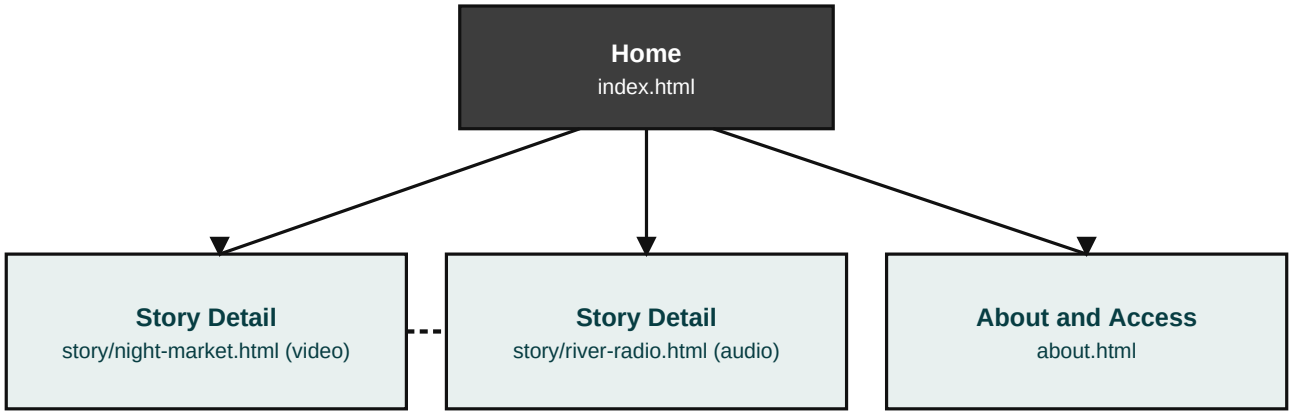
2. Audience and needs

No primary user research has been carried out, so the needs below are assumptions drawn from common accessibility guidance. They are hypotheses to test, not findings.

User	Likely need	How the design responds
Deaf or hard-of-hearing visitor	Understand audio and video without sound	Captions track on video; full transcript on each story

User	Likely need	How the design responds
Blind or low-vision screen reader user	Navigate by landmarks and headings; know what the media contains	Landmarks, one h1 per page, ordered headings, figcaption descriptions, labelled nav
Keyboard-only or switch user	Reach every control without a mouse	Skip link, native controls, visible focus ring, 44px nav targets
Reader on a phone or slow connection	Read instead of stream; use a narrow screen	Transcript available as text, fluid type, stacked layouts, container-aware cards

3. Information architecture



Every page links back to Home through the primary nav. Story pages link to About and Access; About links to the stories. Dashed line: Related stories link between the two story pages.

Navigation model: a single primary navigation labelled Main (Home, Featured story, About and Access) appears on every page and marks the current page with aria-current. Home links to both stories and to About and Access. Story pages link to each other through Related stories, to About and Access through a how-StoryCast-stays-accessible link, and back to Home from the footer. Any page is reachable in two clicks or fewer.

Page purposes

Page	File	Purpose
Home	index.html	Introduce StoryCast and send visitors to the featured stories or to access information.
Story Detail	story/night-market.html, story/river-radio.html	Play one story with captions or a transcript and offer the other story as related content.
About and Access	about.html	Explain the mission, access features and how to take part.

Content hierarchy

Page	Heading outline (from the built pages)
Home	h1 Stories you can see, hear and read. h2 Featured stories (h3 The Night Market, h3 River Radio) h2 Made for everyone
Story Detail	h1 The Night Market (or River Radio) h2 Related stories; transcript in a keyboard-accessible details element
About and Access	h1 About and Access h2 Our mission h2 Accessibility features (h3 per feature) h2 How to engage

4. User journeys

Journey	Steps
1. Discover and open a story	Land on Home; read the hero; scan the two featured story cards (type, title, length, access note); choose Start with a story or open a card.
2. Listen or watch with captions or transcript	On the story page, press play; turn captions on (video) or open the transcript under the player; move to the related story if wanted.
3. Learn about access	From Home (Made for everyone), a story page (How StoryCast stays accessible) or the nav, open About and Access; read the mission and four features; follow How to engage back to a story.

5. Wireframes

Low-fidelity wireframes cover all three page types at desktop (1440 px) and mobile (390 px), plus the River Radio story to show how the template holds audio. Annotations mark the skip link, primary nav, container query, transcript line length and responsive changes. Link: https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=0-1

Page	Mobile (390 px)	Desktop (1440 px)
Home	Brand then nav row; hero; two cards stacked, art above text; Made for everyone block	Header in one row; hero; two cards side by side, each horizontal because its container is wide; Made for everyone block
Story Detail	Title, player, description, transcript, Related stories, all in one column	Main column (player, description, transcript) with a Related stories sidebar
About and Access	One column: mission, four feature cards, three steps, button	Mission line, 2-column grid of feature cards, three steps, button

6. High-fidelity mockups

The mockups use the project's current Sass tokens and real StoryCast content. They sit on the Mockups page of the Figma file: https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=1-2. Frames: Home, Story (Night Market, video) and About and Access at 1440 and 390 px, plus Story (River Radio, audio) at 1440 px. Fonts: Libre Baskerville and Inter stand in for Iowan Old Style / Baskerville and Avenir Next / Helvetica, which Figma does not offer.

Previews of the built site in the current theme

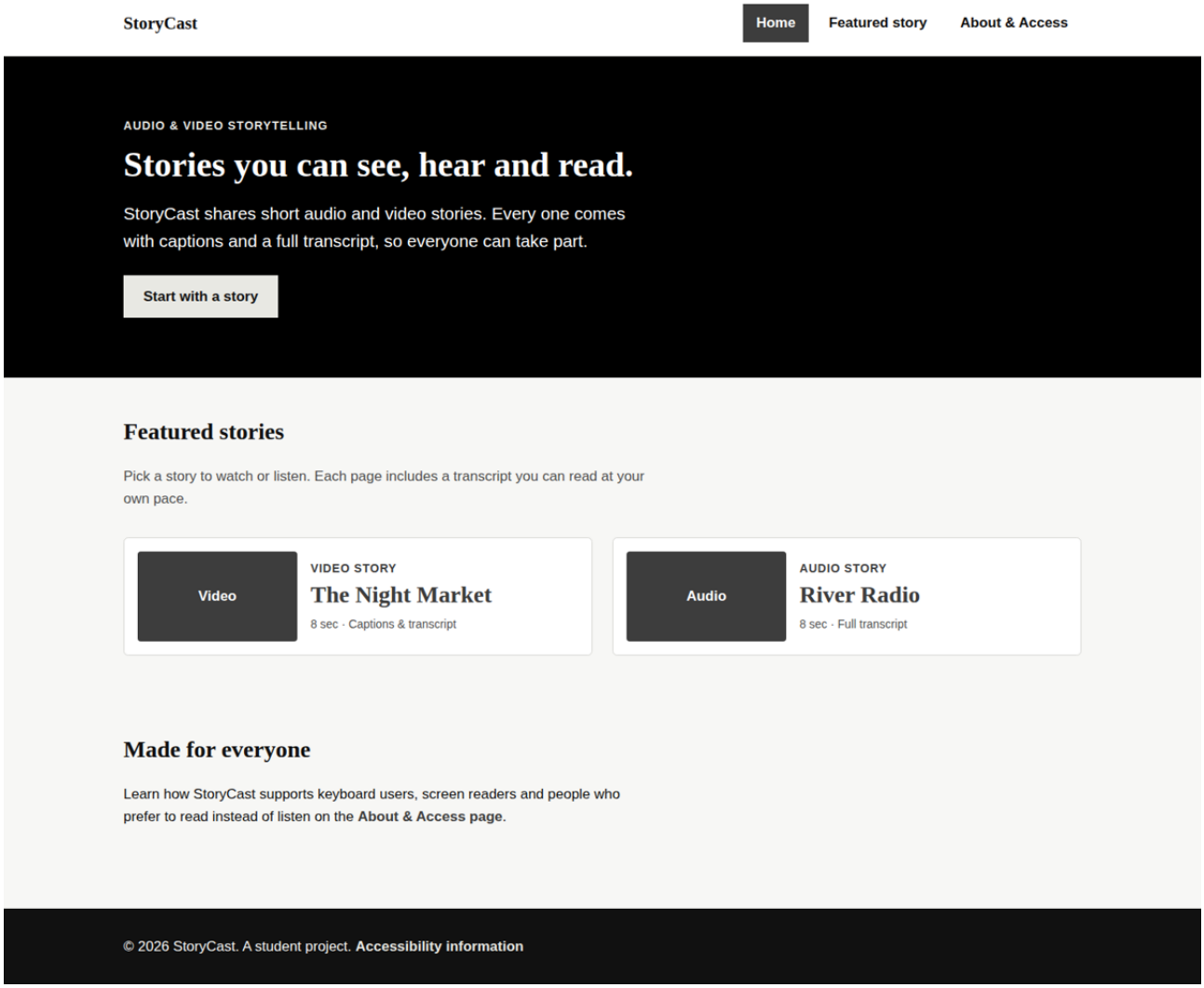


Figure 1. Home, desktop (1440 px), built site.

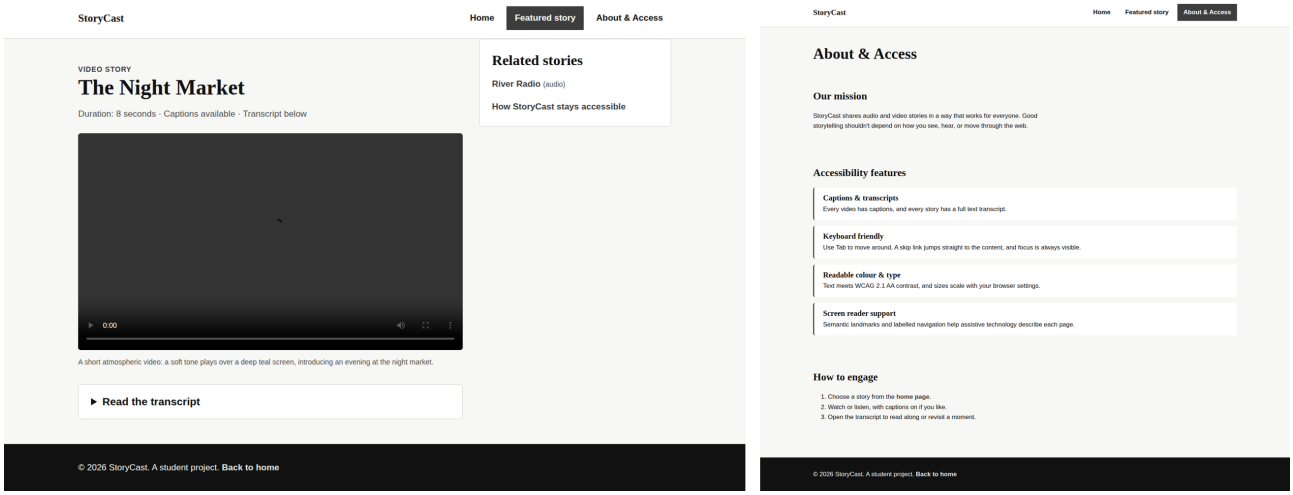


Figure 2. Story Detail (video) and About and Access, desktop, built site.

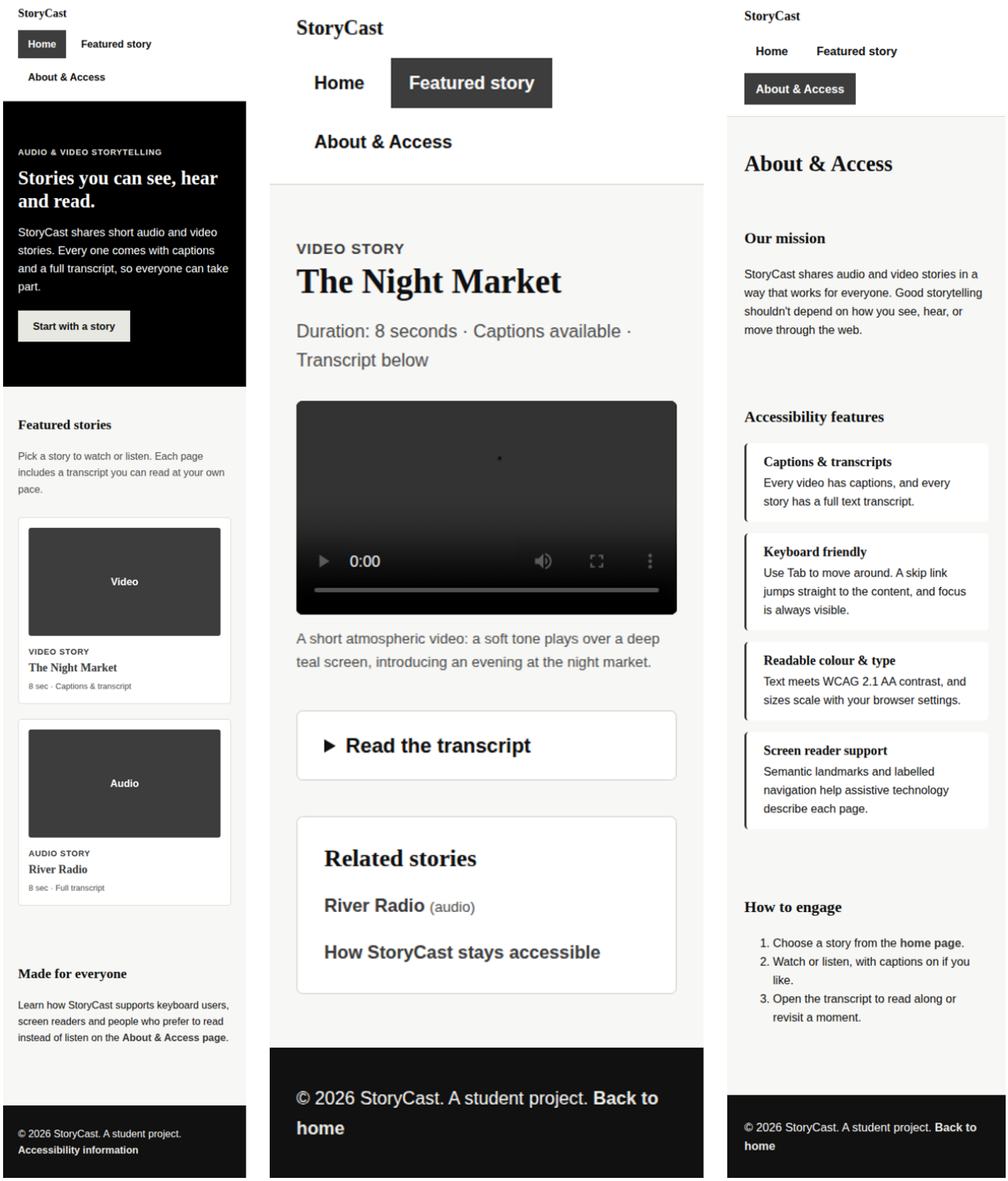


Figure 3. Home, Story Detail and About and Access, mobile (390 px), built site.

These are screenshots of the implementation, shown so the document records how the final design looks. The editable mockups are in Figma.

7. Design system

The system is documented on the Design System page of the Figma file: https://www.figma.com/design/mfgtJK7CL7UW9ZWTaWlhAM?node-id=1-3. Values come from sass/_colors.scss, _typography.scss and _spacing.scss.

Token	Value	Use and contrast (from _colors.scss)
ink	#111111	Text; 17.4:1 on paper
muted	#505050	Secondary text; 7.2:1 on paper
paper	#f7f7f5	Page background
surface	#ffffff	Header, cards
line	#d8d8d4	1px borders
accent	#3d3d3d	Current nav item, card thumbnail; 10.5:1 with white text
accent-strong	#000000	Hero, focus ring, player
highlight	#e8e8e3	Skip link, button, hover
Type	Display: Iowan Old Style / Baskerville / serif. Body: Avenir Next / Helvetica / sans-serif	Fluid scale step--1 to step-3 with clamp()
Spacing	space-1 0.25rem to space-8 4.5rem	Radius 0.35rem; measure 68ch; page width 72rem

Components

- Skip link, site header with Flexbox nav (current page is a filled block with aria-current), hero with eyebrow, lead and button.
- Media card inside a .media-card-wrap container: horizontal at 34rem of container width, meta line hidden below 20rem.
- Player figure with figcaption, transcript in details, related-stories aside, feature cards and numbered steps on About.

8. Responsive behaviour and container query

Sass breakpoints are sm 40rem, md 52rem and lg 72rem. Grid handles the featured-story card grid and the story-plus-sidebar layout; Flexbox handles the header and nav. The container query is the story card: its wrapper sets container-type inline-size and the card changes layout from its own width, so it adapts whether it sits in a wide grid column or a narrow sidebar.

9. Accessibility decisions and checklist

Requirement	How the design and build address it
Captions and transcripts	Video has a captions track; every story has a text transcript in a details element; audio has a downloadable .txt
Contrast	Token pairs recorded in _colors.scss (17.4:1, 7.2:1, 10.5:1)
Keyboard and focus	Skip link, native controls, visible focus-visible outline, 44px nav targets
Structure	Landmarks, one h1 per page, ordered headings, aria-label Main, aria-current page
Media descriptions	Each player in a figure with a figcaption linked by aria-describedby
Motion and zoom	prefers-reduced-motion respected; rem and clamp() type

Verification status: Lighthouse, axe DevTools and WAVE have not yet been run on the pages. Record the scores here once done: [add results]. Claims of WCAG 2.1 AA conformance should rest

on those results and a keyboard and screen reader check.

10. Design rationale (hypotheses, not research findings)

- **Information architecture:** three page types and a persistent nav keep paths short, which should suit stories consumed one at a time.
- **Hierarchy on Home:** a black hero with one light button draws attention to Start with a story; two cards below carry the content.
- **Story page:** player first, transcript directly under it, related story beside or after, so listening, watching and reading are one scroll apart.
- **About and Access:** four short feature cards then three numbered steps, so a visitor learns what exists and how to use it.
- **Monochrome palette:** removing colour keeps focus on the stories and gives high contrast; state is shown by fill, outline and text, never colour alone.

What changed in the theme update

Aspect	Earlier version	Current version
Palette	Teal and yellow on cream	Monochrome: black, greys and off-white
Hero and player	Dark teal	Black
Nav current item	Underline	Filled dark block with white text
Buttons and corners	Pill buttons, 12px radius	Square buttons, 0.35rem radius
Fonts	Georgia and system-ui	Iowan Old Style / Baskerville and Avenir Next / Helvetica

11. How the deliverables meet the rubric

Rubric criterion	Evidence
Semantic structure	index.html, about.html, story/*.html: landmarks, ordered headings, video with track, figcaption, transcripts
Sass and CSS architecture	sass/ partials, tokens as CSS custom properties, BEM, layers reset, tokens, base, layout, components, utilities
Responsive design	Grid and Flexbox layouts; container-queried media card; mobile and desktop frames in Figma
Accessibility	Section 9 and the README checklist; test results to be recorded
Research and documentation	This PDF (sitemap, hierarchy, journeys, wireframes, mockups, design system, rationale), docs/storycast-sitemap.pdf and the Figma file

12. Open items

- Share the Figma file publicly and confirm the links open in a private window.
- Run Lighthouse, axe and WAVE on all four pages and record results in section 9 and the README.
- Add the public GitHub repository link to the title block and README.

- Replace placeholder media with final story recordings if needed.

13. References

- W3C, Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/
- MDN Web Docs, CSS container queries: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/CSS_containment/Container_queries
- Lighthouse accessibility audits (Chrome DevTools); axe DevTools; WAVE by WebAIM